

James Clarke

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EDUCATION

San Diego State University

Bachelor of Science, BS

Major: *Computer Science* Minor: *Mathematics*

Relevant Coursework: *CS470 UNIX System Administration*

San Diego, CA

Expected May 2029

EXPERIENCE

Invitational Collegiate Cyber Defense Competition

Systems Operations / Blue Team Support

- Maintained Linux systems and services during simulated red team attacks while monitoring for suspicious activity
- Analyzed system and network logs to identify indicators of compromise and investigate potential attack vectors
- Conducted network reconnaissance using Nmap to identify exposed services and support system hardening

San Diego, CA

Oct. 2025, Oct. 2026

SDSU Cyber Defense Team

Deputy System Administrator

- Manage a multi-OS virtualized infrastructure supporting club activities, Wireguard VPN, Windows Server, DNS/PKI, Ubuntu, AlmaLinux, FreeBSD, and containerized systems.
- Monitored and deployed VMs and services running Proxmox, Terraform, Ansible, Packer, Forgejo, CI/CD runners, Docker, and LXC containers.
- Built and configured competition VMs while interpreting system administrator playbooks to build a practice Collegiate Cyber Defense Competition environment.

San Diego, CA

April 2026 - Present

SDSU Infrastructure Lab

System Administrator

- Built a multi-OS lab with DNS, LDAP, PKI, SMTP/IMAP, NFS, nginx/Docker, and centralized logging
- Configured UNIX/Linux servers for authentication, mail, file sharing, web hosting, containers, and remote access
- Deployed a multi-node Kubernetes cluster with fault-tolerant web services and automated failover

San Diego, CA

Jan. 2026 - May 2026

San Diego Yacht Club

Deploying Employee Security Systems

- Conducted a cybersecurity risk assessment of the SDYC staff technology practices, systems, workflows, training, and security controls to evaluate confidentiality, integrity, availability, and overall security posture.
- Reviewed access controls, least-privilege practices, and security frameworks to identify risks.
- Collaborated with a team to document observations and develop recommendations to improve the SDYC's security posture.

San Diego, CA

Sept. 2026 - Dec. 2026

SKILLS

Networking & Infrastructure: DNS, LDAP, SMTP, IMAP, NFS, SSH, VPNs, PKI, GitLab, nginx

Security & Log Analysis: Wireshark, tcpdump, Nmap

Systems & Cloud: Azure, Docker, Proxmox, Linux, UNIX administration, UTM, Kubernetes

Operating Systems: OpenBSD, FreeBSD, AlmaLinux, Ubuntu, Solaris, AIX, Windows, macOS

Scripting: Python, C++, Java, Bash

CERTIFICATIONS

CompTIA Security+

Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate

National Cyber League Fall 2025 Team Game & Individual Game

Expected December 2026